Summary

The table below explains the elements mentioned in the different types of تَشْبِيْهٌ and اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ.

تَشْبِيْهٌ (مُفَصَّلٌ مُرْسَلٌ)	تَشْبِيْهٌ مُجْمَلٌ (مُرْسَلٌ)	تَشْبِيْهٌ مُؤَكَّدٌ (مُفَصَّلٌ)	تَشْبِيْهٌ بَلِيْغٌ (مُجْمَلٌ مُؤَكَّدٌ)	اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُصَرَّحَةٌ	اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مَكْنِيَّةٌ
زَيْدٌ كَالْأَسَدِ فِي الشَّجَاعَةِ	زَيْدٌ كَالْأَسَدِ	زَيْدٌ أَسَدٌ فِي الشَّجَاعَةِ	زَيْدٌ أَسَدٌ	جَاءَ أَسَدٌ	زَأَرَ زَيْدٌ
مُشَبَّهٌ	مُشَبَّهٌ	مُشَبَّهٌ	مُشَبَّهٌ	×	مُشَبَّهٌ
مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	×
وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ	×	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ	×	×	×
أَدَاة التَّشْبِيْهِ	أَدَاة التَّشْبِيْهِ	×	×	×	×
					لَازِمُ المُشَبَّهِ بِهِ

Categorisation 3: Extension

In an اسْتِعَارَةٌ, something may be mentioned which matches either the مُشَبَّهٌ or مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ. This is called a مُلَائِمٌ.

The lion entered the debate hall, and with one roar, he caused the opponents to accept defeat.

In this sentence, the word lion is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ used to refer to a brave man. The word roar is a مُلَائِمٌ of the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ.

مُلَائِمُ الْمُشَبَّهِ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْه	مُشَبَّهٌ
roar	--	lion		brave man

According to the مُلَائِمٌ mentioned in an اسْتِعَارَةٌ, there are two types of اسْتِعَارَةٌ.

1. اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُطْلَقَةٌ
2. اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُرَشَّحَةٌ

اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُطْلَقَةٌ

This is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ in which no مُلَائِمٌ is mentioned.

﴿الٓرٰ ۟ كِتٰبٌ اَنْزَلْنٰهُ اِلَيْكَ لِتُخْرِجَ النَّاسَ مِنَ الظُّلُمٰتِ اِلَى النُّوْرِ ۙ﴾

اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُرَشَّحَةٌ

An اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُرَشَّحَةٌ is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ in which a مُلَائِمٌ of the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ is mentioned.

﴿اُولٰٓئِكَ الَّذِيْنَ اشْتَرَوُا الضَّلٰلَةَ بِالْهُدٰى ۠ فَمَا رَبِحَتْ تِّجَارَتُهُمْ﴾

Those are the people who purchased misguidance in exchange for guidance. And their transaction was not profitable.

The word اشْتَرَوْا is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ used to refer to exchange. Later in the verse, the word رَبِحَتْ is mentioned, which is a مُلَائِمٌ of the مَشَبَّهٌ بِهِ.

الِاسْتِعَارَةُ التَّمْثِيْلِيَّةُ

An اِسْتِعَارَةٌ تَمْثِيْلِيَّةٌ is a type of figurative language that uses a comparison to convey a message. For instance, the phrase "You are opening a can of worms" is used metaphorically to imply irreversible consequences.

﴿مَا مِنْ دَآبَّةٍ اِلَّا هُوَ اٰخِذٌۢ بِنَاصِيَتِهَا ؕ﴾

There is no creature, but He holds it by the forelock.

This verse explains that Allah has complete control over every creature.

Note

An اسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ is the use of a single word in its metaphorical meaning, whilst the remaining remain in their literal meaning.

A اسْتِعَارَةٌ تَمْثِيْلِيَّةٌ is the use of an entire sentence in its metaphorical meaning.

الْمَجَازُ الْمُرْسَلُ

A الْمَجَازُ الْمُرْسَلُ is a type of figurative language where the relationship between the literal meaning of the word and the intended meaning is not based on تَشْبِيْهٌ, rather on something closely related to the literal meaning.

Below are some of the عَلَاقَةٌ of مَجَازٌ مُرْسَلٌ.

سَبَبِيَّةٌ

سَبَبِيَّةٌ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is the cause of the metaphorical meaning.

«اَلْمُسْلِمُ مَنْ سَلِمَ الْمُسْلِمُوْنَ مِنْ لِسَانِهِ وَيَدِهِ»

A Muslim is the one from whose tongue and hands Muslims are safe.

Literal Meaning	لِسَانٌ عَلَاقَةٌ	Metaphorical Meaning
tongue hands	سَبَبِيَّةٌ cause	words actions

مُسَبَّبِيَّةٌ

مُسَبَّبِيَّةٌ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is the result of the metaphorical meaning.

﴿وَيُنَزِّلُ لَكُمْ مِّنَ السَّمَآءِ رِزْقًا﴾

And He sends down provision for you from the sky.

Literal Meaning	رِزْقٌ عَلَاقَةٌ	Metaphorical Meaning
sustenance	مُسَبَّبِيَّةٌ result	rain

كُلِّيَّةٌ

كُلِّيَّةٌ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is the whole of the metaphorical meaning.

﴿يَجْعَلُوْنَ اَصَابِعَهُمْ فِيْٓ اٰذَانِهِمْ﴾

They thrust their fingers in their ears.

أَصَابِعُ		
Literal Meaning	**عَلَاقَةٌ**	**Metaphorical Meaning**
fingers	كُلِّيَّةٌ whole	fingertips

جُزْئِيَّةٌ

جُزْئِيَّةٌ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is a portion of the metaphorical meaning.

﴿اَوْ تَحْرِيْرُ رَقَبَةٍ﴾

Freeing of a neck.

رَقَبَةٌ		
Literal Meaning	**عَلَاقَةٌ**	**Metaphorical Meaning**
neck	جُزْئِيَّةٌ part	slave

اِعْتِبَارُ مَا كَانَ

اِعْتِبَارُ مَا كَانَ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is the past state of the metaphorical meaning.

﴿وَاٰتُوا الْيَتٰمٰٓى اَمْوَالَهُمْ وَلَا تَتَبَدَّلُوا الْخَبِيْثَ بِالطَّيِّبِ﴾

Give the orphans their property.

يَتَامَى		
Literal Meaning	**عَلَاقَةٌ**	**Metaphorical Meaning**
orphan	اِعْتِبَارُ مَا كَانَ past state	adult who was an orphan

اِعْتِبَارُ مَا يَكُوْنُ

اِعْتِبَارُ مَا يَكُوْنُ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is the future state of the metaphorical meaning.

﴿قَالَ اَحَدُهُمَآ اِنِّيْٓ اَرٰىنِيْٓ اَعْصِرُ خَمْرًا ۚ﴾

I have seen myself [in dream] pressing wine.

	خَمْرٌ	
Literal Meaning	**عَلَاقَةٌ**	**Metaphorical Meaning**
wine	اِعْتِبَارُ مَا يَكُوْنُ future state	grapes

مُقَارَبَةٌ

مُقَارَبَةٌ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is something near in time or space to the metaphorical meaning.

مَنْ تَرَكَهَا (الصَّلَاةَ) فَقَدْ كَفَرَ

Whoever leaves salah intentionally has (come close to) disbelieving.

	كَفَرَ	
Literal Meaning	**عَلَاقَةٌ**	**Metaphorical Meaning**
becomes a disbeliever	قُرْبٌ proximity	came close to becoming a disbeliever

الْمَجَازُ الْعَقْلِيُّ

الْمَجَازُ الْعَقْلِيُّ is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ in the link between the مُسْنَدٌ إِلَيْهِ and مُسْنَدٌ. i.e., to attribute the فِعْلٌ to someone or something that is not its actual فَاعِلٌ.

﴿إِنَّ فِرْعَوْنَ عَلَا فِي الْأَرْضِ ... يُذَبِّحُ أَبْنَآءَهُمْ﴾

Indeed, Fir'awn had become high-handed in the land ... slaughtering their sons

Fir'awn is described as slaughtering the sons of the Banu Israel. Although he may not have physically carried out the act himself, it is ascribed to him due to his command to his army to do so.

Supplement

المَجَازُ الِاشْتِقَاقِيُّ

الْمَجَازُ الْعَقْلِيُّ can also occur in مُشْتَقَّاتٌ i.e. one مُشْتَقٌّ can be used in the meaning of another.

اِسْمُ فَاعِلٍ in the Meaning of اسْمُ مَفْعُوْلٍ

An اِسْمُ فَاعِلٍ can carry the meaning of an اسْمُ مَفْعُوْلٍ.

﴿فَهُوَ فِي عِيشَةٍ رَّاضِيَةٍ ﴿٢١﴾﴾

He will be in an enjoyable life.

In this verse, the اسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ of رَاضِيَةٌ (happy) is used in the meaning of the اسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ i.e., مَرْضِيَّةٌ (enjoyable)

اِسْمُ مَفْعُوْلٍ in the Meaning of اسْمُ فَاعِلٍ

An اِسْمُ مَفْعُوْلٍ can carry the meaning of an اسْمُ فَاعِلٍ.

﴿حِجَابًا مَّسْتُورًا ﴿٤٥﴾﴾

A covering veil

In this verse, the اسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ of مَسْتُوْرٌ (covered) is used in the meaning of the اسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ i.e., سَاتِرٌ (covering)

Part 3 الْكِنَايَةُ

A الْكِنَايَةُ, allegory, is a figure of speech in which the literal meaning of a sentence is not intended, even though it could be interpreted literally.

For example, the sentence "I don't have blood on my hands" is an allegory used to convey innocence, and it is not intended to be taken literally.

﴿قَالَتْ اَنّٰى يَكُوْنُ لِيْ غُلٰمٌ وَّلَمْ يَمْسَسْنِيْ بَشَرٌ وَّلَمْ اَكُ بَغِيًّا ۝٢٠﴾

Maryam said, "How shall I have a son while no human has ever touched me?"

In this verse the word "touched" is being used as an allegory to convey the meaning of cohabitation, rather than a literal touch.

Unit 3

عِلْمُ الْبَدِيْعِ

Introduction

The sub-science of عِلْمُ الْبَدِيْعِ deals with the aspects of Arabic which are related to embellishments; features that beautify the words or meaning of the sentence. These are called مُحَسِّنَاتٌ.

There are two types of مُحَسِّنَاتٌ:

1) مُحَسِّنَاتٌ مَعْنَوِيَّةٌ: embellishments related to meaning
2) مُحَسِّنَاتٌ لَفْظِيَّةٌ: embellishments related to words

Part 1
مُحَسِّنَاتٌ مَعْنَوِيَّةٌ

الطِّبَاقُ

الطِّبَاقُ is a literary device which involves bringing together opposites. This occurs in various forms.

الطِّبَاقُ with Nouns

طِبَاقٌ can take place with nouns.

﴿هُوَ الْاَوَّلُ وَالْاٰخِرُ وَالظَّاهِرُ وَالْبَاطِنُ ۚ وَهُوَ بِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ عَلِيْمٌ ۝٣﴾

He is the First and the Last, and the Manifest and the Hidden.

الطِّبَاقُ with Verbs

طِبَاقٌ can take place with verbs.

﴿وَاَنَّهٗ هُوَ اَضْحَكَ وَاَبْكٰى ۝٤٣ وَاَنَّهٗ هُوَ اَمَاتَ وَاَحْيَا ۝٤٤﴾

... He is the One who makes laugh and makes weep, and that He is the One who gives death and gives life.

الطِّبَاقُ with a Mixture of Nouns and Verbs

طِبَاقٌ can take place with a mixture of nouns and verbs.

﴿وَمَنْ يُّضْلِلِ اللّٰهُ فَمَا لَهٗ مِنْ هَادٍ ۝٣٣﴾

The one whom Allah deprives of guidance, there is no one to guide.

مُرَاعَاةُ النَّظِيْرِ

مُرَاعَاةُ النَّظِيْرِ is a literary device which involves bringing similar items or elements together.

﴿اَلشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ بِحُسْبَانٍ ۝٥ وَّالنَّجْمُ وَالشَّجَرُ يَسْجُدٰنِ ۝٦﴾

The sun and the moon are [bound] by a [fixed] calculation, and shrubs and trees prostrate.

الْمُشَاكَلَةُ

الْمُشَاكَلَةُ is a literary device which involves expressing a meaning using a word for which it has not been coined. This occurs when two words come in proximity.

﴿فَاعْتَدُوْا عَلَيْهِ بِمِثْلِ مَا اعْتَدٰى عَلَيْكُمْ ۖ﴾

You may transgress against another like they have transgressed against you,

The term اِعْتَدَى means to transgress, exceed, or go beyond limits. This verse suggests that if someone were to transgress and harm another, the victim has the right to seek justice. The word اعتدى is used twice, first in its original meaning and secondly in the meaning of taking retribution.

التَّوْرِيَةُ

التَّوْرِيَةُ is a literary device which involves using a sentence that can have two different meanings, where the listener understands one meaning while the speaker intends another.

When Abu Bakr ﵁ was asked about the person accompanying him during the migration from Makkah to Madinah, instead of saying Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, he would reply:

هَذَا الرَّجُلُ يَهْدِينِي السَّبِيلَ

This man is showing me the path.

The listener would assume he meant a guide who was showing him the path to Madinah whilst he meant the one who was showing him the path to good. By doing this not only did he conceal the identity of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, but he also avoided lying.

تَأْكِيْدُ الذَّمِ بِمَا يُشْبِهُ الْمَدْحَ

تَأْكِيْدُ الذَّمِ بِمَا يُشْبِهُ الْمَدْحَ is a literary device which involves emphasizing a criticism in a way that makes it sound like a compliment.

﴿فَلَا صَدَّقَ وَلَا صَلّٰى ۝٣١ وَلٰكِنْ كَذَّبَ وَتَوَلّٰى ۝٣٢﴾

So [the denier of the Hereafter] neither believed, nor prayed, but rejected the truth and turned away [from it].

In this verse, the word but and the following sentence is used to create the expectation that the following sentence will mention something positive after the initial criticism, but instead another negative trait is mentioned, implying that everything about the person being described is inherently evil.

تَأْكِيْدُ الْمَدْحِ بِمَا يُشْبِهُ الذَّمَ

تَأْكِيْدُ الْمَدْحِ بِمَا يُشْبِهُ الذَّمَ is a literary device which involves emphasizing a praise in a way that makes it sound like a criticism.

﴿لَا يَسْمَعُوْنَ فِيْهَا لَغْوًا وَّلَا تَاْثِيْمًا ۝٢٥ اِلَّا قِيْلًا سَلٰمًا سَلٰمًا ۝٢٦﴾

They will hear neither an absurd talk in heaven, nor something leading to sin, but [they will hear] the words of Salam, Salam [as greetings].

In this verse, the word but and the following sentence is used to create the expectation that the following sentence will mention something negative after the initial praise, but instead another positive trait is mentioned, implying that everything about Heaven is good.

Part 2

مُحَسِّنَاتٌ لَفْظِيَّةٌ

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز is a literary device which involves concluding a text or speech with the initial topic or theme. This occurs in various forms.

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز Within A Verse

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز can take place within a verse.

﴿اَتَخْشَوْنَهُمْ ۚ فَاللّٰهُ اَحَقُّ اَنْ تَخْشَوْهُ﴾

Were you were fearing them? Allah is more entitled to be feared by you.

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز Within A Chapter

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز can take place within a surah.

The beginning and end of سُوْرَةُ الْقَلَمِ comprise of the same topic: refuting the allegation that the Prophet is insane.

The first verses are as follows:

﴿نٓ وَالْقَلَمِ وَمَا يَسْطُرُوْنَ ۝١ مَآ اَنْتَ بِنِعْمَةِ رَبِّكَ بِمَجْنُوْنٍ ۝٢﴾

By the pen and what they write, with the grace of your Lord, you are not insane.

The final verses are as follows:

﴿وَاِنْ يَّكَادُ الَّذِيْنَ كَفَرُوْا لَيُزْلِقُوْنَكَ بِاَبْصَارِهِمْ لَمَّا سَمِعُوا الذِّكْرَ وَيَقُوْلُوْنَ اِنَّهٗ لَمَجْنُوْنٌ ۝٥١ وَمَا هُوَ اِلَّا ذِكْرٌ لِّلْعٰلَمِيْنَ ۝٥٢﴾

And they say, "He is a madman indeed." And it is nothing else but a Reminder for all the worlds.

السَّجَعُ

السَّجَعُ is a literary device which involves ending each verse or sentence with a similar pattern or rhyme.

﴿طٰهٰ ۝١ مَآ اَنْزَلْنَا عَلَيْكَ الْقُرْاٰنَ لِتَشْقٰٓى ۝٢ اِلَّا تَذْكِرَةً لِّمَنْ يَّخْشٰى ۝٣ تَنْزِيْلًا مِّمَّنْ خَلَقَ الْاَرْضَ
وَالسَّمٰوٰتِ الْعُلٰى ۝٤ اَلرَّحْمٰنُ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ اسْتَوٰى ۝٥ لَهٗ مَا فِى السَّمٰوٰتِ وَمَا فِى الْاَرْضِ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا وَمَا
تَحْتَ الثَّرٰى ۝٦ وَاِنْ تَجْهَرْ بِالْقَوْلِ فَاِنَّهٗ يَعْلَمُ السِّرَّ وَاَخْفٰى ۝٧ اَللّٰهُ لَآ اِلٰهَ اِلَّا هُوَ ۚ لَهُ الْاَسْمَآءُ الْحُسْنٰى
۝٨﴾

الْجِنَاسُ

الْجِنَاس is a literary device which involves using words with same or similar pronunciations but different meanings.

﴿وَيَوْمَ تَقُوْمُ السَّاعَةُ يُقْسِمُ الْمُجْرِمُوْنَ ۙ مَا لَبِثُوْا غَيْرَ سَاعَةٍ ۭ﴾

And on the Day when the Hour takes place, the sinners will swear that they did not remain [in the graves] more than one moment.

الْقَلْبُ

اَلْقَلْبُ is a literary device which involves structuring a sentence or phrase in a way that it can be read forwards and backwards.

﴿كُلٌّ فِيْ فَلَكٍ يَّسْبَحُوْنَ ۝٤٠﴾

Each one in an orbit.

قَلْبٌ takes place in the first three words of this verse.

ك	ل	ف	ي	ف	ل	ك

بَرَاعَةُ الْاِسْتِهْلَالِ

بَرَاعَةُ الْاِسْتِهْلَالِ is a literary device which involves using an eye catching statement to initiate a text or speech.

﴿سُبْحٰنَ الَّذِیْۤ اَسْرٰی بِعَبْدِهٖ لَیْلًا مِّنَ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ اِلَی الْمَسْجِدِ الْاَقْصَا الَّذِیْ بٰرَكْنَا حَوْلَهٗ لِنُرِیَهٗ مِنْ اٰیٰتِنَا ؕ اِنَّهٗ هُوَ السَّمِیْعُ الْبَصِیْرُ ۝۱﴾

Glorious is He Who made his servant travel by night from Al-Masjid-ul-Haram to Al-Masjid-ul-Aqsa whose surroundings We have blessed.

حُسْنُ الْخِتَامِ

حُسْنُ الْخِتَامِ is a literary device which involves using an eye-catching statement to end a text or speech.

﴿دَعْوٰىهُمْ فِیْهَا سُبْحٰنَكَ اللّٰهُمَّ وَتَحِیَّتُهُمْ فِیْهَا سَلٰمٌ ۚ وَاٰخِرُ دَعْوٰىهُمْ اَنِ الْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ رَبِّ الْعٰلَمِیْنَ ۝۱۰﴾

And the end of their call will be, “All praise be to Allah, the Lord of all the worlds.”

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